

Evaluation of an Interactive Multimedia Exhibit in the National Museum of Korean Contemporary History, South Korea

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KAIST

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We explore
the impact of media and technology
on the museum

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NATIONAL MUSEUM OF KOREAN CONTEMPORARY HISTORY

National Museum of Korean Contemporary History

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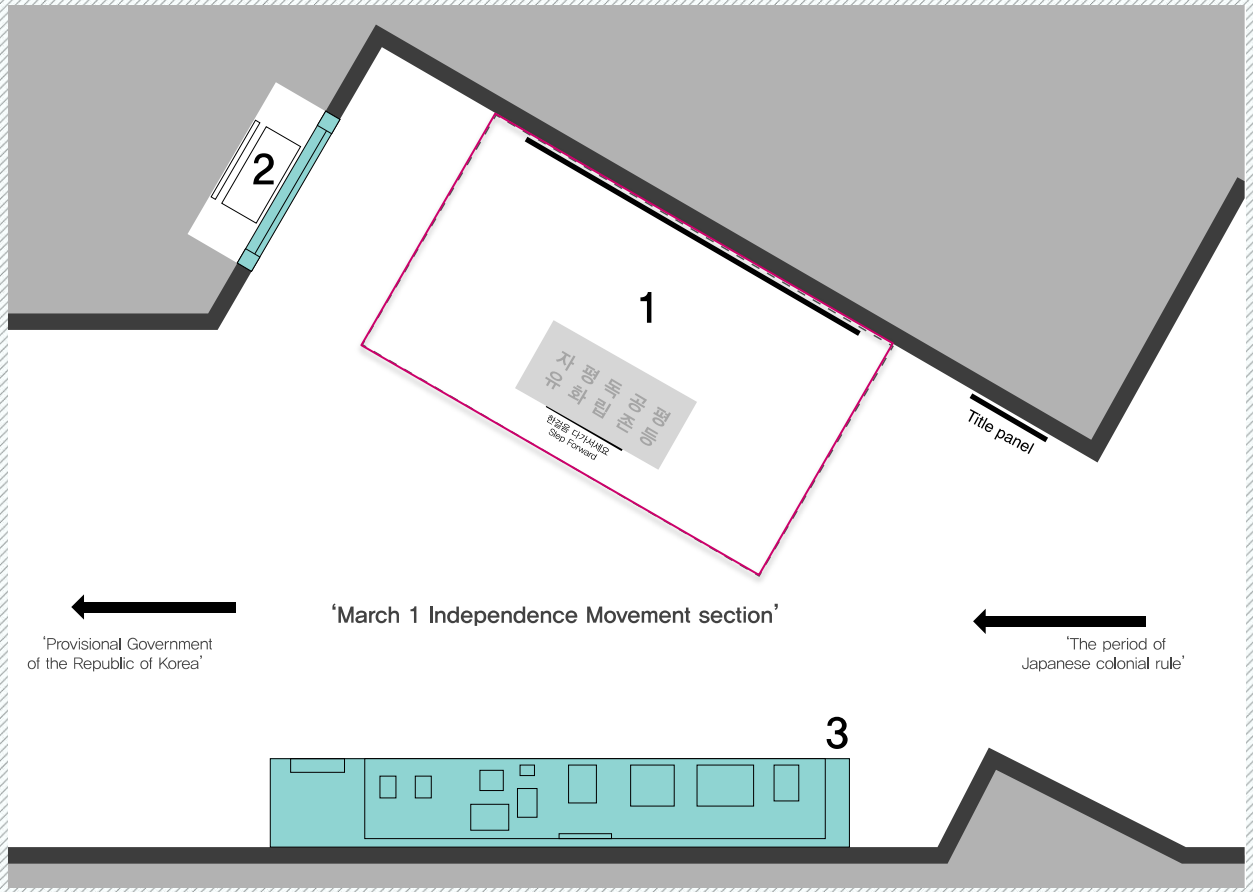


Digilog Strategy

(Digital+Analogue)

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1. An Interactive Multimedia Exhibit



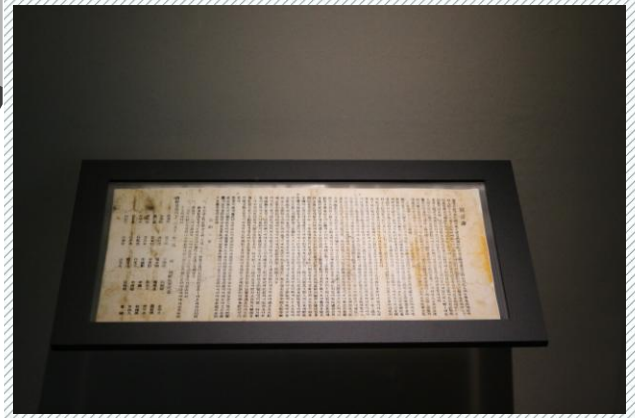


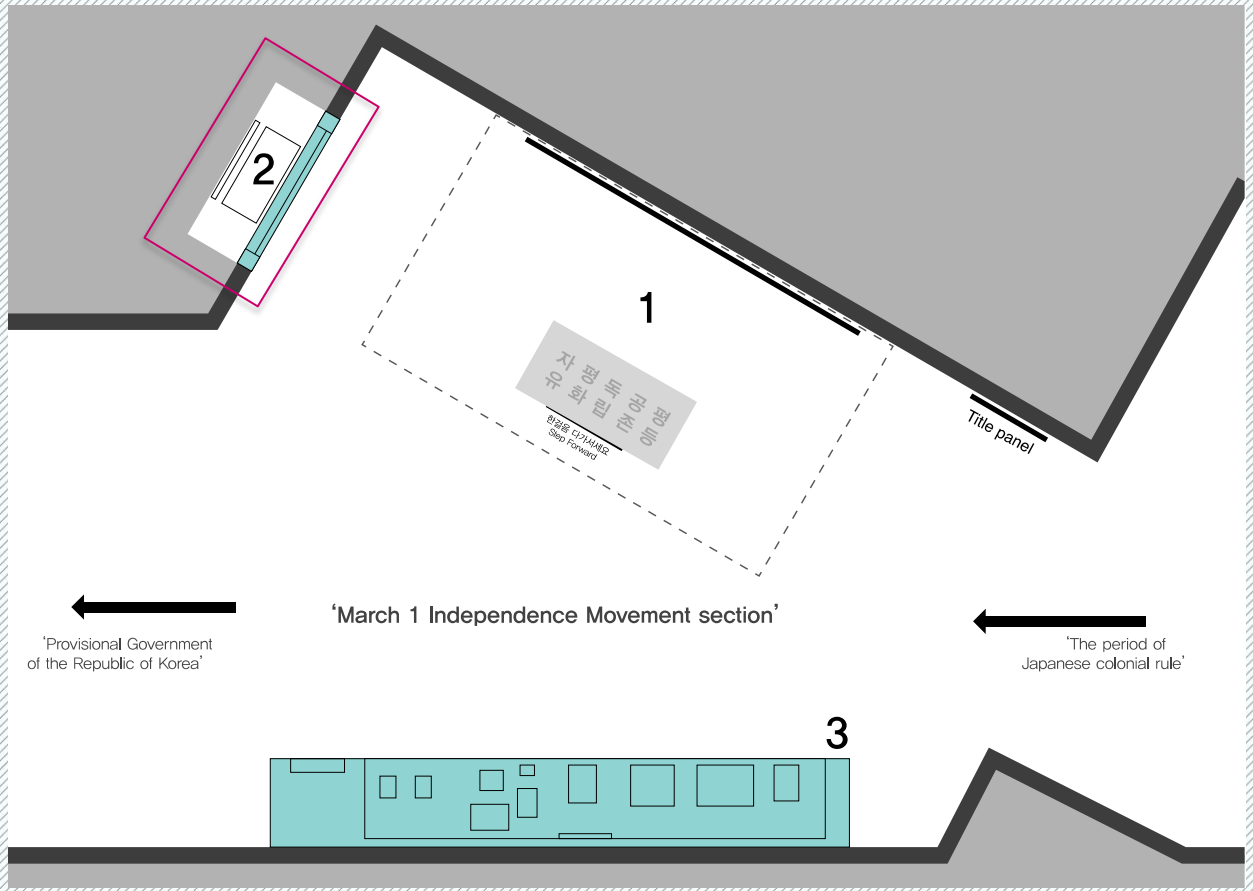
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2. Showcase
the original copy
of the March 1st Declaration
of Independence

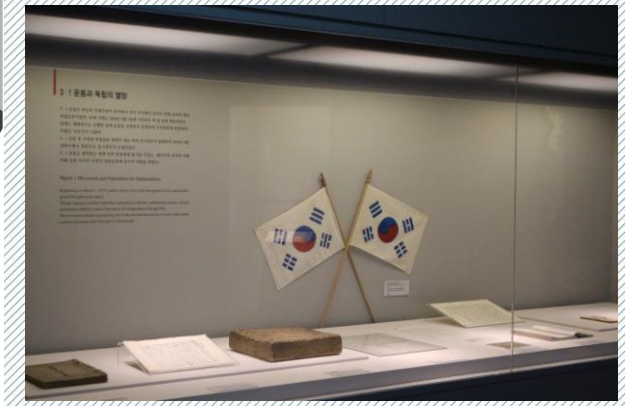


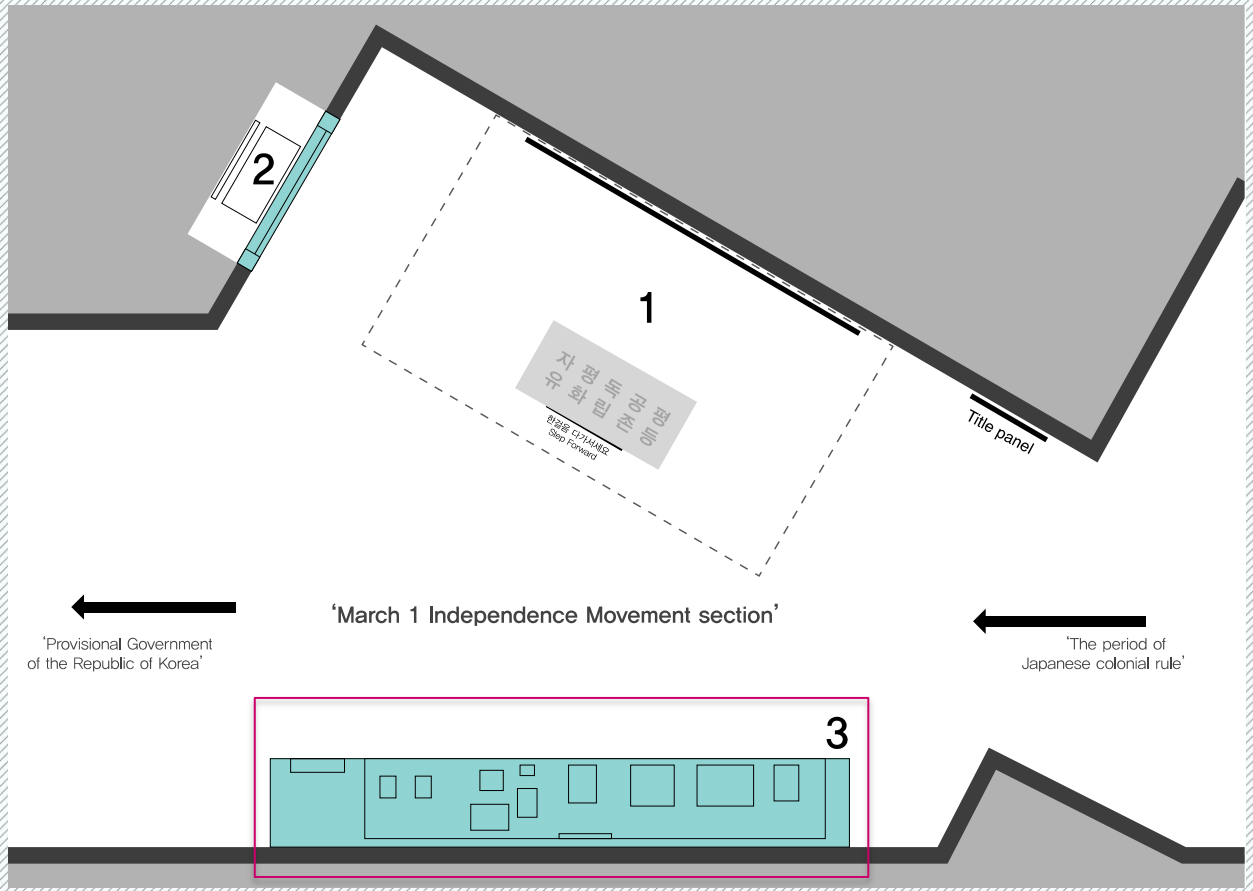


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3. Showcase

a showcase of 11 pieces
of related historical objects





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Research Questions

The study sought to provide new empirical data about the following issues:

- **Does the interactive multimedia exhibit achieve desirable purpose?**

  attraction → interaction → learning

- **Does the interactive multimedia exhibit provoke visitors' interest in other exhibits in the section?**

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Method

study on exhibition visitors



Preliminary observation

Video observation
(sample: 200)

Interviews
(sample: 60)

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Method

Preliminary observation

This stage of observation that took place before the actual research enabled us to categorize visitors into three categories

Video observation
(sample: 200)

Interviews
(sample: 60)

A Visitors who **interacted with** the interactive multimedia exhibit

B Visitors who **did not interact but watched** others interacting

C Visitors who did not view the interactive multimedia exhibit but **viewed other exhibits in this section** of the exhibition

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Method



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Method

- **Preliminary observation**
- **Video observation**
  (sample: 200)
- **Interviews**
  (sample: 60)

A sample of 200 visitors from the crowded hours of 2pm-5pm on Saturday and Sunday were analyzed

Behavioral coding scheme:

-Information regarding the basic particulars

-viewing category

-average time spent at this section of the exhibit

-the order in which the exhibits were viewed from all of the visitors from categories (A),(B), and (C)

-took special note of how many people viewed the actual artifact that this exhibit was based on after seeing the exhibit

-visitor's methods of interaction with the interactive multimedia exhibit based on the intended interaction stages of the exhibit

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Method

- **Preliminary observation**
- **Video observation**
  (sample: 200)
- **Interviews**
  (sample: 60)

interviews with 20 visitors from each viewing category

For visitors in category (A), we asked:

- how they discovered the interactive multimedia exhibit
- why they decided to interact with it
- how much they understood from the exhibit
- whether it inspired interest in the other exhibits of the section

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Method

- **Preliminary observation**
- **Video observation**
  (sample: 200)
- **Interviews**
  (sample: 60)

For visitors in category (B), we asked:

- the same questions as those in (A) with an additional question why they chose to only watch and not interact with the exhibit themselves

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Method

- **Preliminary observation**
- **Video observation**
  (sample: 200)
- **Interviews**
  (sample: 60)

For (C) category visitors, we asked:

- why they chose not to view this exhibit

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Results 1

Attraction & interaction

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit achieve its desirable purpose?

All visitors **N:200 (100%)**

Visitors in the exhibits **N:129 (64%)**

Visitors in the interactive exhibit **N:91 (45%)**

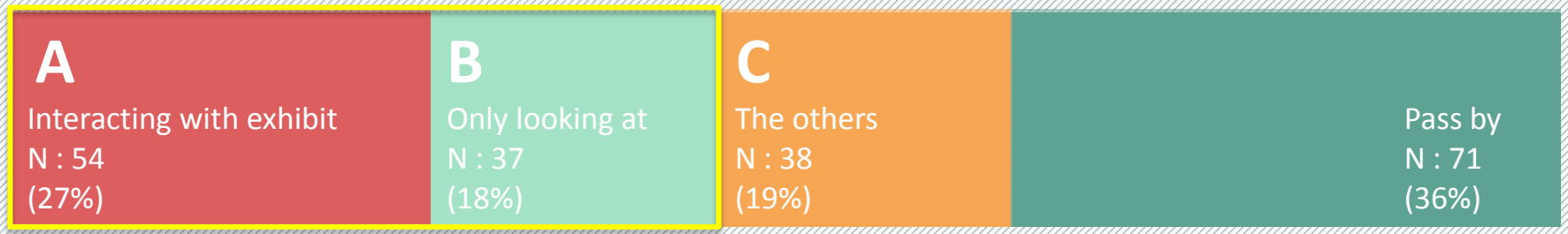


Figure 1: Rate of Visitors Falling Under Each Category

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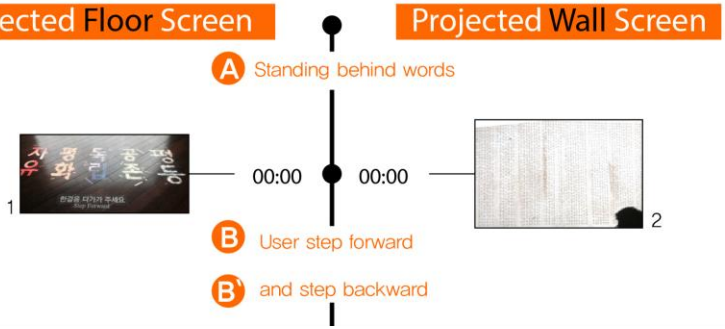
Results 2

Learning

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit achieve its desirable purpose?

A
Interacting with exhibit
N : 54
(27%)

8 46
All step



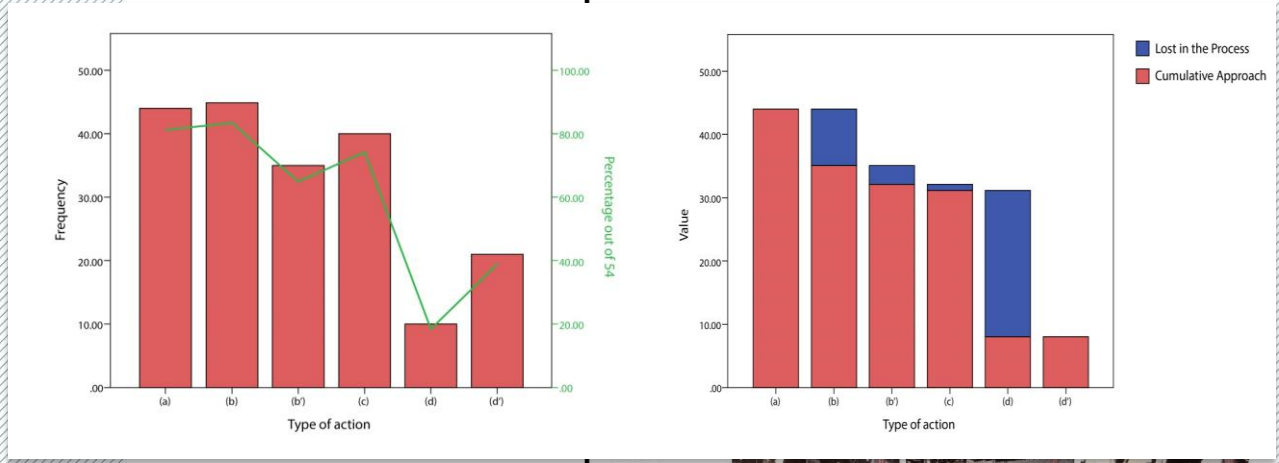
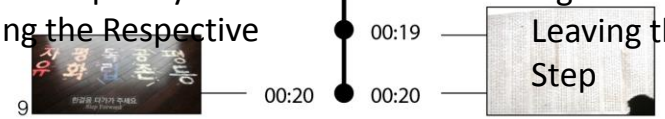


Figure 2: Frequency of Watching the Respective Steps

Figure 3: Number of People Leaving the Exhibit by Each Step





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Results 2

Learning

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit achieve its desirable purpose?

The understanding of the exhibit based on three levels,

level 3 complete understanding of the contents of the exhibit
-no one

level 2 know what the content is about and how it works
- 4 people

level 1 know only recognized the theme (Declaration of Independence)
- 16 people

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Results 3

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit provoke visitor's interest in other exhibits in the section?

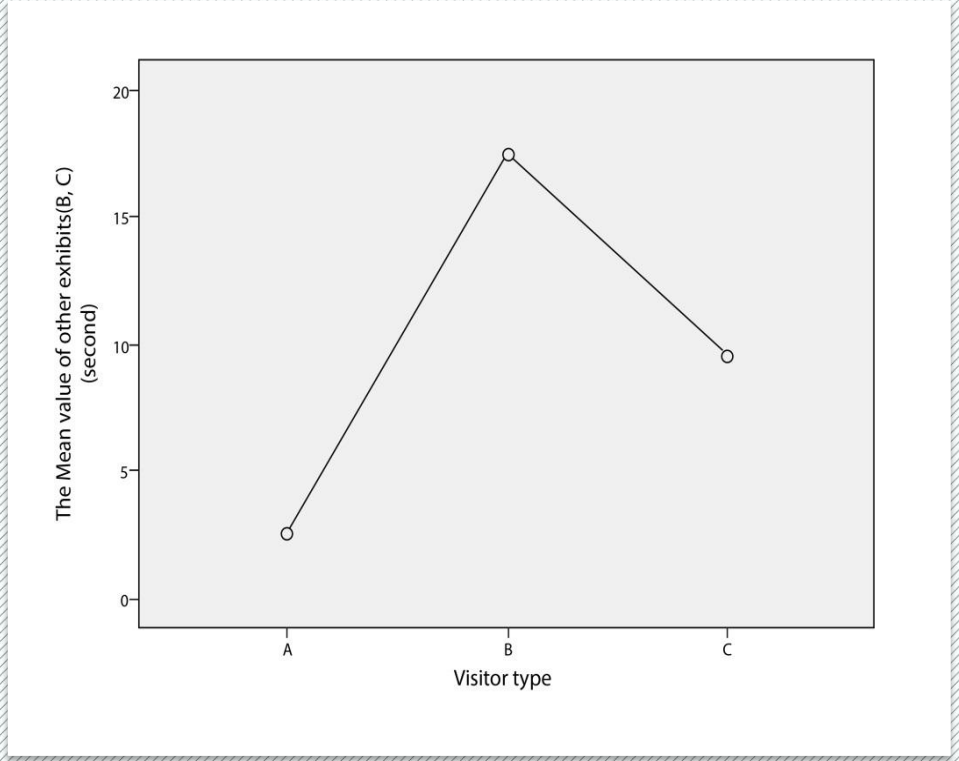


Figure 4: The Average Time Period Watching Other Exhibits of the Section by Each Category

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Discussion 1

Attraction & interaction

Does the interactive multimedia
exhibit achieve its desirable purpose?

The importance of intuitive design
interaction behavior could be affected by the social group, such as family

Suggestion

It is necessary to design an interactive multimedia exhibit that can be easily and intuitively learned and used

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Discussion 2

Learning

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit achieve its desirable purpose?

Why this exhibit was not successful in terms of the visitors learning. In this case, This is related to interface design issues

Suggestion

- visitor input is of crucial importance in designing interactive multimedia exhibits
- the method of interaction should be relevant with the content
- the function of interaction should not be limited to simply pushing a button.

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Discussion 3

Does the interactive multimedia exhibit provoke visitor's interest in other exhibits in the section?

Did a sense of accomplishment that the interaction arouse among the visitors from category (A) led to reduced interest in other exhibits?

Suggestion

it is crucial to establish a complementary relationship between the interactive multimedia exhibit and the objects displayed

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Conclusion

- Even though the interactive multimedia exhibit functioned successfully as an attention grabber, it failed to fulfill its potential in contributing to a meaningful experience for visitors

- Therefore, it is important to thoroughly consider how to use the interactive multimedia exhibit as a connecting point between both visitor-exhibit and exhibit-exhibit when designing interactive multimedia exhibits